Maya Gerdes

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EDUCATION

University of Michigan - Ann Arbor, MI GPA: 3.96/4.00 | Expected May 2028

B.S. in Biopsychology, Cognition, and Neuroscience; Honors Program | Minors: Entrepreneurship, Business (Ross School of Business)

- **Relevant Coursework:** Calculus I-III, Programming & O.O.P. Concepts, Statistics & Data Analysis, Honors Physics I/II
- **Honors**: Branstrom Prize (Top 5% of class); James B. Angell Scholar (4.00 GPA, 3 semesters); Phi Kappa Phi; Nu Rho Psi
- **Programs**: Ballard Academy for Student Entrepreneurs Accelerator; MCombinator Accelerator; UStart League Accelerator
- **Awards**: 1st Place – a16z NY Tech Week Build & Pitch Hackathon (2026); 1st Place – Google DeepMind NYC Hackathon (2026); 1st Place – UM Business+Tech UStart League Accelerator Demo Day (2026)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Praxigen, Inc., *Founder & CEO* - New York City, NY Apr 2026 - Present

- Founded HealthTech startup (AI prior-authorization platform) piloted across 10+ specialty practices, cutting submission time 80% across insurance PA and appeal workflows with 100% approval/overturn across 40+ submissions
- Designed, built, and deployed MVP of full-stack platform grounded in 1,300+ payer requirements with AI-native features: case management, clinical note checks, audit logs, automated payer calls, and KPI analytics/insights from product use
- Led team of 3 developers and 3 BDRs across product development, prioritizing roadmap from customer feedback and shipping features from discovery to launch; A/B tested AI agent writing feature across ~50 users to improve usability KPIs
- Led 120+ provider interviews and GTM, translating workflow pain points into product requirements, generating 600K+ LinkedIn impressions, and delivering technical demos to 80+ practice leaders, achieving 20% trial conversion

Michigan Blockchain Consulting, *Product Manager* - Ann Arbor, MI Aug 2025 - Present

- Led 3 developers from requirements through launch of ForeverData, a permanent file-storage product on EigenDA; defined roadmap, UX and wallet upload flow, and product requirements to simplify decentralized storage before sale to Eigen Labs
- Led product/GTM strategy for 4 blockchain clients, translating user needs into product requirements and launch plans

Michigan Medicine, Department of Human Genetics, *Research Assistant* - Ann Arbor, MI Aug 2025 - May 2026

- Engineered CRISPR constructs for a patent-pending DNA-sensing system targeting cancer-specific genomic alterations; used SnapGene modeling and experimental data to diagnose failures and improve system performance
- Led recruiting/onboarding to scale wet-lab team to 15+ researchers; built protocols and documentation for new members

Michigan Medicine & College of Engineering, *Research Assistant* - Ann Arbor, MI Nov 2024 - Sept 2025

- Conducted translational research across computational vascular biomechanics lab and clinical research in cardiovascular surgery, integrating wet-lab and computational approaches to improve vascular imaging & reconstruction in surgical planning
- Analyzed and organized pre- and post-operative CABG and cardiac catheterization datasets for 1,500+ patients, utilizing Epic and Excel to inform statistical analysis and data-driven clinical research on patient outcome prediction and improvement

Neuropsychiatry & Forensic Neurology Private Practice, *Intern* - New York City, NY May 2025 - Aug 2025

- Engaged in outpatient neuropsychiatric clinical workflows, including diagnostic evaluations, cognitive assessments, and treatment planning across 50+ patient cases
- Formulated structured interview protocols based on clinical context, forensic evidence, and behavioral assessments for 12+ forensic neuropsychiatric evaluations, improving data collection accuracy for expert witness testimony and case development

LEADERSHIP

Cancer Screening Advocates, *President & Founding Campus Lead* - Ann Arbor, MI Nov 2025 - Present

- Launched first university chapter of national cancer-prevention nonprofit; built partnership with Michigan Medicine and led campus education and fundraising initiatives reaching 1K+ students and raising $10K+

Pi Sigma Epsilon, Ross Professional Business Fraternity, *Speaker Chair* - Ann Arbor, MI Jan 2025 - May 2026

- Led all outreach to industry professionals/partners, building cross-functional relationships for 120+ attendee speaker events

ADDITIONAL

Technical Skills: Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, R, C++; React, Supabase, Vercel, GitHub, Excel, Power BI, Tableau, MATLAB
AI/ML: LLMs, RAG, model evaluation, prompt design, OpenAI/Claude APIs, Lovable, Cursor
Product Skills: Roadmapping, user research, A/B testing, product analytics, GTM, competitive analysis, Figma, Jira, UX design
Interests: HealthTech, Entrepreneurship, Pickleball/Fitness, Music (piano, guitar, DJing), Cognitive Science, AI/Frontier Tech